FAQs

Transferring files

I often need to take work home and I do this by copying files to a removable media and then copying them back onto my home computer's hard disk. After I've finished my work, I copy the files to the removable media again, so I can cart it back to work. Is there a better way to transport files between my work and home computers?

Ramez Mistry
Via e-mail

There's an old DOS command that makes it much easier to transfer files. This command works with hard drives, Zip drives, CD-RW (via packet-writing software such as Roxio's Direct CD) and other removable media.

Right-click a blank space on the desktop or in Windows Explorer's right pane and select ***New > Shortcut***. In the Create Shortcut wizard, enter ***xcopy "import folder name*.*" x:\transfer /d /y /s***. Here, 'import folder name' is the location and name of the folder you want to copy and 'x' is the drive letter of your removable medium. For instance, if you want to copy from c:\Windows\Desktop\Work via your floppy drive (a:), enter ***xcopy "C:\Windows\Desktop\Work*.*" a:\transfer /d /y /s***. Click Next and name the shortcut 'Export'. Click Next, choose an icon for the shortcut if you want to, and then click Finish. In Windows 98 and Me, right-click the shortcut and select Properties. Under Program, check 'Close on exit' and click OK.

Now select the Export shortcut and press ***[Ctrl] + [C]***, then ***[Ctrl] + [V]*** to create a new shortcut called Copy of Export. First rename this as Import and then right-click it and select Properties. Click the Program tab and reverse the two paths so that the one to the transfer folder on your removable medium comes before the one to the hard drive folder. For instance, change the example above to xcopy a:\transfer "C:\Windows\Desktop\Work*.*" /d /y /s. Click OK.

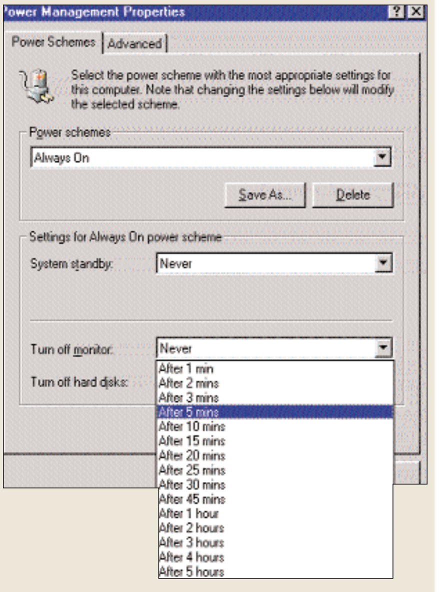
Create similar shortcuts on your home computer.

Next time you want to transfer files, put a disk in the drive and click your Export shortcut. To access the contents on the other machine, put the disk in the computer and click the Import shortcut.

Save Our Screen

I have heard that running a screensaver program prevents the screen from burning out and helps prolong the life of the monitor. Is it true? What else can I do to prolong the life of my monitor?

Mitoo
Via e-mail



Set Windows to automatically shut down the monitor after a certain period of inactivity

In the days of monochrome monitors, characters (such as the C:\ prompt in DOS) and images could get permanently burned into the screen if the screen was left static for too long. Today's monitors are sturdier.

The best thing you can do to prolong the life of your monitor is to switch it off when not in use. You can set Windows to automatically power down the screen if it's been inactive for a certain period of time. If you have Windows 98 or Me installed, click ***Start > Settings > Control Panel > Power Management***. Under the Power Schemes tab, select a time from the drop down menu next to 'Turn off monitor'.

Your monitor's worst enemies are heat and water—add a fan if your display is running hot and keep it safe from moisture.

stuck during games or if I play music while working in Photoshop. Please help.

Santosh R.
Via e-mail

The reason for your RAM problem is that your motherboard doesn't support 512 MB RAM DIMMs. The 815 chipset motherboards have three DIMM slots that together support a total of 512 MB RAM—they don't support a solitary 512 MB DIMM. If you exchange your RAM for two 256 MB modules, it will show up correctly.

Regarding your gaming woes, even a very old GeForce is more than enough to play *Quake III Arena*, unless you are playing the game at a resolution over 1024x768. Also, disable the motherboard's onboard graphics from the BIOS and/or the Device Manager. Make sure that you have the latest Intel chipset drivers (for the motherboard) and the latest nVidia drivers (for the GeForce graphics card) installed. Finally, make sure you have the latest version of DirectX (***www.microsoft.com/directx***).

If you want hassle-free audio, consider replacing the onboard audio with a soundcard. But before you spend any money, check that the audio problem is not because you have the wrong drivers loaded for your onboard audio. If you do decide on a soundcard, make sure you uninstall your audio drivers and turn off the onboard audio in the BIOS or via the motherboard jumper before you install the soundcard.

Did I kill my graphics card?

I recently bought a new PC with 512 MB of PC2100 DDR SDRAM, an AMD Athlon XP 2100+ processor, a GeForce4 Ti 4600 graphics card and a KT333 motherboard. Everything was working fine, till I exchanged the graphics card with the one in my old computer—now I am unable to boot. I've put back the GeForce4 in my new machine, but still nothing. Have I caused my graphics card some serious damage?

Shiv
Via e-mail

The most likely reason for your trouble is that you've shaken something lose while you were switching cards. But just to make sure that your GeForce4 is still fine, try booting your older PC with the card installed in it.

To fix your new PC, reinsert the GeForce4 and make sure it's firmly in place. Also reseat the other components such as the memory and power to make sure that nothing came lose while you were tinker-